

SHIO LIM

Cornell University
Department of Sociology
323 Uris Hall, Ithaca, NY 14853
csl235@cornell.edu

Curriculum Vitae

EDUCATION

- 2023– Ph.D. Candidate, Sociology, Cornell University
Concentration areas: Social Inequality (emphasis on health) and Sociology of Culture
Committee: Dan Hirschman (Chair), Vida Maralani, and Jamie Budnick
- 2025 M.A., Sociology, Cornell University
- 2019 B.A., Gender and Sexuality Studies & Ethnic Studies (with Honors), Brown University
Honors Thesis: “Check Your Preferences: Desirability Politics and Intimate Discrimination On and Offline.”

AREAS OF INTEREST

Mental Health, Medical Sociology, Sociology of Culture, Qualitative Methods, Religion and Spirituality, Science and Technology Studies

WORKING PAPERS

Lim, Shio. “Psychotherapy in Unsettled Times: How Therapists Mediate Between Collective Crises and Personal Distress.” [under review] [[link to preprint](#)]

Lim, Shio. “How Can You Prove That Your Soul Is Healing?” Spirituality and the Boundaries of Legitimate Care in Psychotherapy.”

Maralani, Vida, Shio Lim, and Celene Reynolds. “Perceptions of Sex Discrimination by Gender and Race at U.S. Universities, 1994-2014.”

Budnick, Jamie and Shio Lim. “Imagining Family and the Future: A Qualitative Content Analysis of Climate Change Concern and Reproductive Decision-Making.”

GRANTS

- 2026 Graduate Studies Enhancement (GSE) Grant, Social Science Research Council (SSRC)-Mellon Mays Graduate Initiatives Program. \$2,000.
- 2025 Pre-doctoral Research Development (PRD) Grant, Social Science Research Council (SSRC)-Mellon Mays Graduate Initiatives Program. \$3,000.

2024 Graduate Studies Enhancement (GSE) Grant, Social Science Research Council (SSRC)-Mellon Mays Graduate Initiatives Program. \$2,000.

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

2025 Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation (NSF GRFP).

2024 Health Policy Research Scholars (HPRS) Program, Robert Wood Johnson Foundation (RWJF).

2024 Southeast Asian Program Foreign Language and Area Studies (FLAS) Fellowship, Cornell University.

2019 Best Student Paper and Presentation Award, 51st annual “Let the Body Rejoice” conference, American Association of Sexuality Educators, Counselors, and Therapists (AASECT).

2018 BrownConnect LINK Award, Brown University.

2018 Edward Guiliano '72 Global Fellowship, Brown University.

2017 Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellowship (MMUF), Andrew Mellon Foundation.

2017 Marla Ruzicka International Public Service Fellowship, Brown University.

CONFERENCES & INVITED TALKS

“Psychotherapy in Unsettled Times: How Therapists Mediate Between Collective Crises and Personal Distress” paper presented at the “Sociology of Mental Health Care” Open Paper Session at the 2026 annual American Sociological Association (ASA) Conference, August 10, 2026.

“Psychotherapy in Unsettled Times: How Therapists Mediate Between Collective Crises and Personal Distress” paper presented at the 18th Annual Sociology Graduate Students Association (SGSA) Symposium at Cornell University, February 27, 2026.

“Reclaiming the Sacred: How Therapists in the San Francisco Bay Area Negotiate Spirituality in Clinical Practice” paper presented at the “Religion and the Therapeutic” Open Paper Session at the 2025 annual American Sociological Association (ASA) Conference, August 12, 2025.

“Kids and the Climate Crisis: Narratives of Reproductive Decision-Making in the Unprecedented Present and an Unimaginable Future” co-presented with Dr. Jamie Budnick at the Reproductive Justice Roundtable at the 2025 annual American Sociological Association (ASA) Conference, August 11, 2025.

“Kids and the Climate Crisis: Narratives of Reproductive Decision-Making in the Unprecedented Present and an Unimaginable Future” co-presented with Dr. Jamie Budnick at the Action for Climate Justice: Contributions from Social Science Climate Justice conference at Yale University, March 2025.

“The Role of Spirituality in Psychotherapy: A Comparative Study of Traditional and Holistic Approaches to Contemporary Crises” presented at the Sociology Graduate Students Association (SGSA) Symposium at Cornell University, March 21, 2025.

“Ctrl + D(esire): Desirability Politics and its Discontents,” workshop and Late Night Conversation presented as an invited guest speaker at Brown University’s 14th Annual Sex Week “SHAG’s Greatest Hits,” March 17, 2023.

“Check Your Preferences: Desirability Politics, Intimate Discrimination, and the Ethics of Desire in the Contemporary Sex-and-Dating Landscape,” presented at *The Sexual Health School* (credit offered to participants working toward their Sexuality Education Certificate and AASECT certification), December 10, 2021.

“Check Your Preferences: Desirability Politics and Contemporary Discourses on Sex, Dating, and Intimacy,” presented at the 51st annual “Let the Body Rejoice” conference held by the American Association of Sexuality Educators, Counselors, and Therapists (AASECT), June 13-16, 2019.

“Check Your Preferences: Desirability Politics and Contemporary Discourses on Sex, Dating, and Intimacy,” honors thesis presented at the Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellowship (MMUF) Senior Research Presentation, Brown University, May 3, 2019.

Opening speaker, Feminist Leadership and Mentorship for Equality (FLAME) Conference, Brown University, March 18, 2019.

“The Politics of Desirability: Decolonizing Sex,” Research Slam Presentations and Final Reception, Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellowship UCLA Summer Writing and Research Training Program, August 3, 2018.

“Academia and its Influences on the 2009 Recriminalization of Sex Work in Rhode Island,” research paper presented at the “(De)stigmatising Sexscapes: Politics, Policy and Performance” session at the American Association of Geographers (AAG) Annual Conference, April 5-9, 2017.

L A N G U A G E S

Burmese: native language, advanced proficiency in speaking, reading, and writing

Spanish: intermediate proficiency in speaking, reading, and writing

Mandarin and Cantonese: basic proficiency